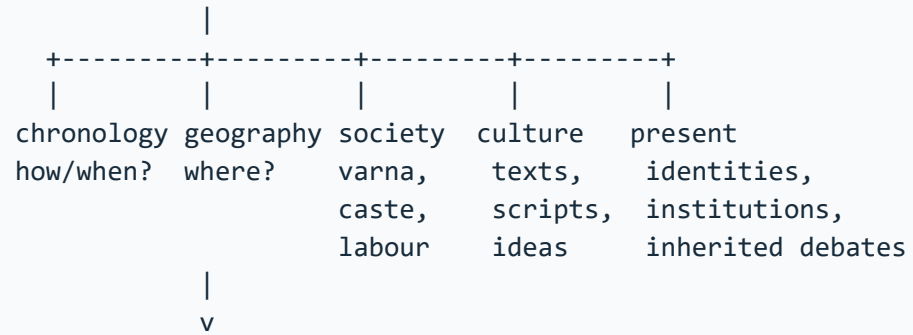


ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/12: Why ancient India matters: the complete inquiry

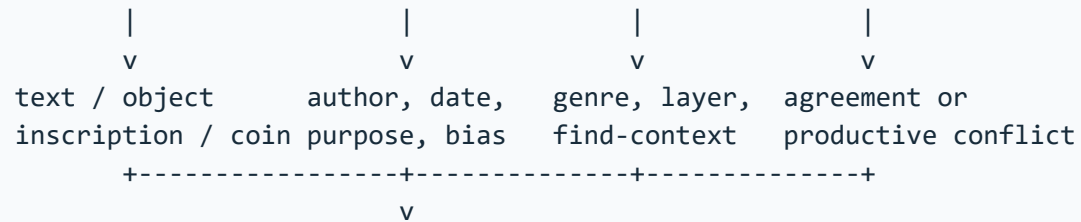
ANCIENT INDIA: WHY STUDY IT?



History is reconstruction of change through evidence, not a memory-list of rulers.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/12: From surviving trace to historical claim

SURVIVING TRACE -> SOURCE CRITICISM -> CONTEXT -> CORROBORATION -> HISTORICAL CLAIM



PROVISIONAL EXPLANATION WITH STATED LIMITS

Rule: absence of evidence may reflect preservation, excavation or elite silence.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/12: Historiographical schools: claims and corrections

ORIENTALIST -> IMPERIAL/COLONIAL -> NATIONALIST -> MARXIST -> SOCIAL/SUBALTERN TURNS

texts and antiquity admired	despotism, stagnation, period labels	agency and unity, achievement	mode, class, gender, caste, surplus, production	tribe, labour, ecology, region
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No school is a neutral final word: compare question, evidence, category and silence.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/12: Periodisation without communal boxes

PROBLEM: Hindu / Muslim / British labels make rulers religion the clock of history.

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RESPONSE: use overlapping processes, not sealed civilisational blocks

polity: lineage -> state -> empire -> regional formations

economy: foraging -> farming -> towns -> agrarian expansion

society: kinship -> varna ordering -> jati proliferation -> local negotiation

culture: oral/textual traditions + material practice + cross-regional exchange

VERDICT: dates organise; processes explain; regional change is asynchronous.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/12: Unity in diversity: a historical mechanism

ECOLOGICAL + LINGUISTIC + ETHNIC DIVERSITY

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migration + intermarriage + trade + pilgrimage + conquest + textual circulation

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local persistence

shared repertoires

crops, cults, speech

epics, scripts, sacred places, state forms

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UNITY = repeated interaction and accommodation; not primordial sameness.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/12: Varna, caste and social history

NORMATIVE VARNA TEXTS ----- prescribe ranked fourfold order

|

| must be tested against

v

INSCRIPTIONS + ARCHAEOLOGY + REGIONAL TEXTS + OCCUPATIONAL PRACTICE

|

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HISTORICAL FIELD: jati, labour, gender, tribe, mobility, exclusion, patronage

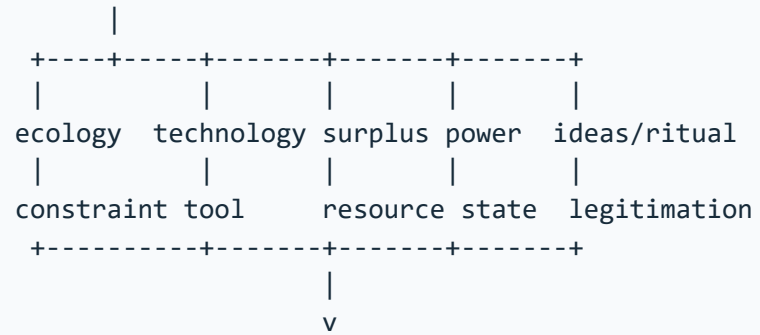
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Neither timeless rigidity nor automatic fluidity: institutions changed unevenly.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/12: Causation: explanation beyond great men

HISTORICAL CHANGE



Agency selects among conditions; no single factor mechanically determines outcome.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/12: Bias, silence and ethical reconstruction

ARCHIVE OVER-REPRESENTS: rulers | donors | literate elites | durable materials

ARCHIVE UNDER-REPRESENTS: women | labourers | forest groups | oral communities

|

v

CHECK: who produced it? for whom? what genre? what was unlikely to survive?

|

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|

read statement critically

|

read silence cautiously

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VERDICT: recover plurality without inventing voices the evidence cannot supply.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/12: Historiography answer architecture: 10/15/20 marks

10 MARKS: define historiography -> name 2 schools -> one evidence contrast -> verdict

15 MARKS: frame issue -> colonial claim -> nationalist reply -> material/social turn
-> source example -> limitation of each -> balanced judgement

20 MARKS: question/category -> school timeline -> evidence architecture -> neglected
groups/regions -> periodisation dispute -> present stakes -> synthesis

MUST NAME: source, historian/school, explanatory gain, residual blind spot.

CLOSE: ancient history is plural, evidence-led reconstruction, not usable myth.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 10/12: Evidence ladder and confidence control

EVIDENCE LADDER

1. Separate verified source fact, historical inference and current-status claim.
2. Topic 01 owns method; Topic 02 owns detailed source classes and techniques.
3. Write claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation.

VERDICT: Source type controls the strength and limits of the historical claim.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 11/12: Examiner traps and contested boundaries

CLOSE DISTINCTIONS

1. Attribute contested readings; name their evidence and counter-evidence.
2. Inscriptions record claims; coins show circulation, not uniform territorial rule.
3. Co-relate sources; texts are layered and normative, material evidence interpreted.

VERDICT: Qualification earns marks; false certainty is a hard failure.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 12/12: Integrated answer spine and qualified conclusion

ANSWER SPINE

1. Define the demand and the controlling historiographical question.
2. Build each paragraph as claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification.
3. Compare schools by question, archive, contribution and residual blind spot.

VERDICT: Evidence and method rank plural readings without pretending finality.